CHAPTER TWENTY-FOUR

The Jews, Israel, and Palestinian Replacement Theology

Giovanni Matteo Quer

Replacement theology was for centuries a widely-accepted view within the Catholic Church proclaiming the termination of Israel's biblical Covenant following the advent of Jesus and the formulation of a New Covenant based on the Gospel. The notion of Jews' rejection of Jesus led to a number of anti-Judaic views, including the accusation of deicide. Following the Second World War, Jewish-Catholic reconciliation reinterpreted the relationship between Christianity and Judaism in the sense of continuity, partially vindicating the Jewish origins of Christianity. Even so, the anti-Judaism that was rooted in replacement theology has not vanished. While anti-Judaism and antisemitism in Catholicism within the framework of conservative Catholic thought have been analysed, the views on Jews and Israel of the so-called "Catholic Left" have been studied to a lesser extent. Emerging in the 1980s, the Catholic Left at first combined its social doctrine with quasi-Marxist and antisemitic tenets protraying Jews as capitalist oppressors. Catholic-Marxist thought had evolved in South America and South Africa in the years after the Second World War, advocating freedom from dictatorship and racial oppression. A Christian Left also developed in Protestant and other non-Catholic churches. In the context of the Arab-Israeli conflict, the Palestinian Christian churches progressively elaborated a theological advocacy of the Palestinian cause that draws on Marxist and pacifist Christian views. By integrating human rights and pacifist doctrines in liberation theologies, the new Christian Left is advancing a two-fold replacement theology, which suppresses the Jewish biblical narrative (replacing it with the Christian interpretation) and theologically substitutes Palestinian claims for the Jewish national and historical narrative.[1]

Copyright © 2016. Nebraska. All rights reserved.

Anti-Judaism, Antisemitism, and Delegitimizing Israel, Nebraska, 2016. ProQuest Ebook Central,